A-A-51373A
22 August 1986
SUPERSEDING
A-A-0051373(DM)
31 March 1986

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

GOWN OPERATING, SURGICAL

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to A-A-0051373(DM), 31 March 1986.

This commercial item description covers one size of a sterile, disposable, operating gown with towel suitable for preventing bacterial migration into the sterile field.

Salient characteristics:

The surgical pack shall consist of a large size, disposable, non-woven sterile surgical operating gown with towel.

The gown shall conform to the following minimum dimensions in inches:

LOCATION	DIMENSION (MINIMUM)
Chest	56
Front Length	45
Sweep	61
Sleeve inseam (exclusive of wristlet)	22
Belt Length	15

The surgical operating gown shall be full length with a generous overlapping back closed with plastic snap fasteners at the neck area. These fasteners shall be applied to a non-woven ribbon made from the gown body material. The ribbon is attached to the gown by sewing. Three (3) male snaps on the left flap and two (2) female snaps are on the right flap. The gown shall have four (4) tie tapes, two (2) on the outside and two (2) on the inside, approximately at waist level. The tie tapes shall be attached by sewing to the gown. The gown shall have a non-woven neck binding sewn to neck area of gown body.

The gown shall have full length raglan sleeves set in by sewing. The sleeves shall have wristlets made of tubular knit polyester fabric.

AMSC N/A FSC 6532

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The gown shall be fabricated from a soft, pliable, fluid resistant non-woven material. The material shall have good resistance to dry-particle penetration. The material shall have high breathability, and shall be comfortable to wear for long periods. The color of the material shall be light pastel shades of blue, green or blue-green.

Each gown shall be supplied with a scrim reinforced, absorbent towel. The towel shall have minimum dimensions of 19 by 23 inches.

Each gown and towel shall be folded and overwrapped in a white non-woven fabric. Two (2) individually folded and wrapped gowns with towels shall be packaged in a white heat-sealed bag which is tear-resistant and which will allow aseptic handling and maintain sterility of the contents until opened or damaged.

The surgical gown and towel in its immediate container shall be sterile when tested with a biological indicator (or alternate method) as specified in the sterility test.

A certificate of sterility stating that samples from each sterilization lot have been tested and found to be sterile, shall be submitted to the procuring activity. The certificate of sterility shall include:

a. Item Identification.
b. National stock number.
c. Contract or purchase order number.
d. Sterility lot or control number.
e. Date of sterilization.
f. Quantity of product in the sterilizer lot.
g. Type of sterilization (gas, radiation, heat, steam, etc.)
h. Form of biological indicator (i.e., inoculated paper spore strip or carrier, inoculated product, or inoculated simulated product).
i. Test organism(s) and population density used.
j. Test medium, incubation temperature, incubation time, and dates of tests.
k. Number of test units.
l. Statement that samples comply with sterility tests.
m. Signature of head of laboratory or a designated qualified alternate.

Workmanship. The gowns shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing 16 sterile surgical packs (each pack containing two gowns and two towels), as specified, constitutes one unit.

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Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contact or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one (1) operating gown with towel. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for examination shall be conducted at Inspection Level II, AQL 2.5 and sampling for tests shall be conducted at Inspection Level S-1, acceptance number is zero.

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Sterility test. The surgical gowns shall be treated for sterility in accordance with the method specified in the U.S. Pharmacopeial Convention Publication: Pharmacopeia of the United States, Mack Publishing Co., Easton, PA 18042 (USP), for purified cotton, gauze, surgical dressings and related material using inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). The incubation temperature shall be as listed below. Product containing a biological indicator shall be marked or labeled, so that it clearly differentiates from product intended for product intended for distribution. The incubation medium and minimum time in each case shall be soybean casein digest for 7 days for inoculated product. The minimum number of test units, regardless of lot size, shall be 10, except for inoculated carrier which shall be 20. For sterilization, the organism used shall be as listed below:

Type of Sterilization	Organism	Incubation Temperature Degrees C
Steam	B.stearothermophilus	55 - 65
Dry Heat	B.stearothermophilus	55 - 65
	B.subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30 - 35
Gas	B.subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30 - 35
Radiation	B. pumilus	30 - 35

The number of viable cells shall be sufficient to provide assurance that the product has been sterilized.

Inoculated carriers (paper spore strips) if used shall be in accordance with MIL-S-36586. Other paper carriers shall be inoculated to be of equivalent resistance. The method, incubation and number of test units shall be as indicated herein for inoculated product or simulated product. The method of sterilization will control the organism in the spore strip to be tested for as shown above.

NOTE: When an inoculated carrier is chosen, product samples must also be tested as required by the USP.

Alternate method. Suppliers conducting sterility tests in a manner other than that indicated herein shall submit proof that the alternate method provides equal assurance concerning the sterility of the product. Requests for approval of any alternate method of testing for sterility shall be made to the Contracting Officer, and approval obtained before employment of the alternate method on a Government contract. Dosimetry release as approved by FDA is acceptable.

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Product testing. Testing for sterility of the product after receipt by the Government shall be without a biological indicator and in accordance with the USP.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

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NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

6532-01-053-8544

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

PGC 58505

Project No. 6532-1170

Location: CID/GOWN-OPERG-SURG/H15-3

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-51373A	GOWN, OPERATING, SURGICAL

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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